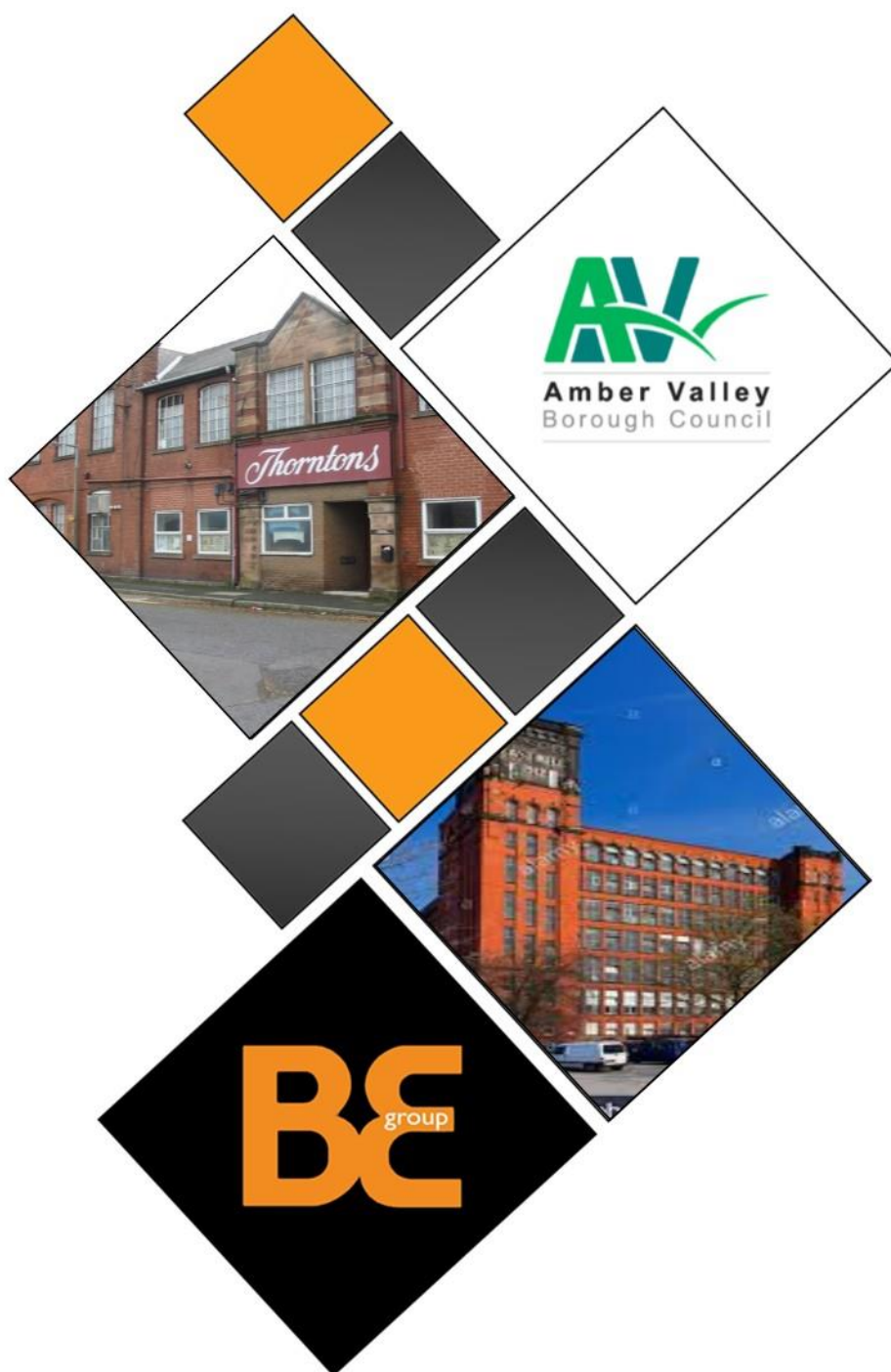




Amber Valley Local Plan Examination, Employment Areas Assessment

Amber Valley Borough Council

Final Report

March 2025

CONTENTS

1.0	INTRODUCTION	3
2.0	BACKGROUND – 2021 EMPLOYMENT LAND REVIEW	6
3.0	EMPLOYMENT AREAS ANALYSIS	9
4.0	CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS	14

1.0 INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 The Amber Valley Borough Local Plan 2022-2040 was submitted to the Secretary of State on 29th July 2024, by Amber Valley Borough Council (the Council), for an Examination in Public (EIP) held by Inspectors appointed by the Planning Inspectorate (PINS). Hearing sessions for that EIP were completed in December 2024. Following those sessions, in a letter dated 7th January 2025, the Planning Inspectors identify a range of actions which need to be undertaken to ensure the soundness of the Local Plan. Of relevance here is the action set out in Paragraphs 21 and 22 of that letter, namely:

“...To reflect changes to the Use Classes Order the Council have suggested a modification which would restrict changes of use within the E class to those within the previous use class B1. The aim of the changes to the Use Classes Order is to facilitate a wider range of uses within employment areas and so a blanket removal of such rights would not be consistent with the aims of national policy.

However, as put to us at the hearing, there may be locations within the Borough where the loss of existing employment units to uses outside the previous B Use Classes would undermine the ongoing functioning of the employment area. Therefore, in support of this modification the Council should identify which of the existing employment areas they consider should have permitted development rights restricted and why, reflecting the quality of the employment sites the Council is seeking to maintain and the contribution the employment area makes to the wider employment supply in the Borough.”

- 1.2 To achieve this, it has been requested by the Council that BE Group undertake a review of the 25 main Employment Areas of Amber Valley Borough, updating the assessment completed in Section 7.0 of the Amber Valley Employment Land Review (2021) (EIP Document Ref. ED02), also completed by BE Group. The aim of this assessment is to identify those Areas suitable greater protection against changes of use in the ‘E’ Use Class, as noted above, and those lower grade areas which may benefit from such changes.
- 1.3 BE Group, economic development and property consultants, compiled this report during February – March 2025.

Methodology

1.4 Research methods used include:

- *Vacancy/Transactions Review* – Using the EGi Radius database to identify vacant property in each Area. This is combined with a review the total number of units in each Area, derived from the Nimbus database, to identify the current vacancy rates. Past transactions, were also be reviewed to identify which Areas have the most active property markets
- *Development Review/Stakeholder Engagement* – Available monitoring data was reviewed to identify what small scale developments have occurred in the Areas since 2021 and what is consented for the future. This shows what locations have been the focus for local investment. BE Group also engaged with relevant members of the Council Local Plans and Economic Development Team, to discuss the performance of Areas and the hierarchy of industrial estates/business parks in Amber Valley
- *Area Physical Review* – A review of physical constraints within the 25 Areas, such as flood risk, pylons and pipelines in the Area to identify Areas with practical barriers to growth
- *Revised Grading* – Drawing together the above data, an updated review of the 25 Areas was completed. For consistency with the wider Local Plan evidence base, this will include an updated grading of the Areas, using the grading system of the Amber Valley Employment Land Review (2021) (see Table 1). Based on this, recommendations are provided as to which Employment Areas should receive protection against changes of use in the Local Plan.

Table 1 – Amber Valley Employment Land Review: Employment Area Grades Definitions

Grade	Definition	Action
Good	High quality, prestigious, flagship business areas due to their scale, location and setting. Capable of competing for investment in the regional market place. These are prime sites for marketing to a cross section of users including new inward investors. They can also meet the needs of image-conscious, aspirational companies already in the Borough.	Protect strongly Support and expand
Above average	Good employment sites due to their scale, location and setting. Capable of competing for investment in the sub-regional market place. These are prime sites for marketing to a cross section of users, B1, B2 and B8, including some new inward investors.	Protect strongly Support and expand

Average	Key employment sites with an influence over the whole Borough but primarily geared towards local businesses and B1 (E(g)(iii)) light industrial, B2 and B8 uses.	Protect Support
Below average	Lower quality locations often in residential areas suffering from poor accessibility and massing.	Assess whether to protect/review through the Local Plan
Poor	Very poor-quality areas. Widespread vacancy and dereliction in poor environments.	Promote alternative uses if possible

Source: BE Group, 2021

2.0 BACKGROUND – 2021 EMPLOYMENT LAND REVIEW

- 2.1 Section 7.0 (Pages 124-131) of the Amber Valley Employment Land Review (2021) (EIP Document Ref. ED02), undertook an assessment of the Amber Valley's 25 main Employment Areas to provide guidance as to their continued viability. This updated research undertaken in the 2008 and 2016 Employment Land Reviews.
- 2.2 The 25 Areas were appraised and assessed through a combination of online research, local intelligence, consultations with landowners and the views of those involved in the local property market. Each Area was graded good-poor, as per the grading system in Table 1 above. This grading was based on several factors – the critical mass of the area, companies like to be together; accessibility, the closer to arterial transport routes the better; prominence, to main roads; servicing and car parking area, the extent and quality of this; and environment.
- 2.3 The 25 Areas comprised 497.48 ha of land, 54.4 percent of which is within the Alfreton and Somercotes area. The 25 Areas, and their gradings in 2021, were:

Alfreton/Somercotes

- Site 1¹: Meadow Lane IE, Alfreton (26.10 ha) – Average grading – Grading based on area quality and its slightly constrained access
- Site 2: Cotes Park IE, Alfreton (Incorporating Alfreton Trading Estate) (174.24 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the scale and quality of the Area, plus its strong access to the A38
- Site 3: Alfreton IE/Thornton Park, Alfreton (32.45 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the presence of the strategic Thorntons manufacturing facilities and its strong access to the A38
- Site 4: Pye Bridge IE, Somercotes (20.21 ha) – Below average grading – Grading reflects the bad neighbour uses here, low quality of the premises and constrained local access
- Site 5: Greenhill Lane IE, Riddings (17.60 ha) – Average grading – Grading based on area quality and its slightly constrained access

¹ Site numberings, used throughout this Assessment, relate to the Employment Area Mapping provided as Appendix 7 of the Amber Valley Employment Land Review (2021).

Ripley

- Site 25: Riverside/Bullbridge Hill, Ambergate (15.64 ha) – Below average grading – Grading reflects the low quality of the premises and poor access
- Site 26: Denby Hall Business Park (23.64 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a high-quality modern business park, accommodating a range of major employers, close to the A38
- Site 6: Peasehill IE, Peasehill (17.09 ha) – Average grading – Grading based on area quality and its slightly constrained access
- Site 7: Butterley Works – Derelict site with a past consent for housing. Not included in the Submission Local Plan Policy ED1
- Site 8: Codnor Gate IE, Ripley (26.14 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the quality of the buildings, and the good access
- Site 9: Heage Road IE, Ripley (6.46 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the presence of larger B2/B8 units here

Heanor

- Site 10: Chrysalis Business Park/Langley Bridge Industrial Estate, Langley Mill (8.51 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a highly accessible, modern development
- Site 11: Access 26, Langley Mill (21.67 ha) – Above average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a highly accessible, modern development accommodating some major employers
- Site 12: Bailey Brook IE, Langley Mill (4.41 ha) – Average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a small, typical industrial estate, in part offering small business units
- Site 13: Sawmills Industrial Park, Heanor Road, Heanor (13.53 ha) – Average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a moderate quality mid-sized industrial estate, with reasonable main road access
- Site 14: Heanor Gate IE, Heanor (36.47 ha) – Average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this a large, but moderate quality industrial estate
- Site 15: Cromford Road, Langley Mill (1.64 ha) – Below Average grading – Grading reflects the older nature of premises here
- Site 16: Langley Park/Eastview Terrace, Langley Mill (3.31 ha) – Average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this is a Moderate quality small

business industrial estate in a mostly residential area, with some access constraints

Belper²

- Site 17: North Mill and East Mill, Belper – Historic Mill premises with mixed use proposals. Not included in the Submission Local Plan Policy ED1
- Site 18: West Mill, Belper – Former Courtaulds site. Now vacant. Not included in the Submission Local Plan Policy ED1
- Site 19: Derwent Street, Belper – Cleared site. Not included in the Submission Local Plan Policy ED1
- Site 20: Derby Road, Belper – Historic mill premises, in use as an antiques centre. Not included in the Submission Local Plan Policy ED1
- Site 22: Bullsmoor, Nottingham Road/Kilburn Road, Belper (14.82 ha) – Average grading – Grading reflects the fact that this accommodates a large factory for Vaillant, albeit in a more isolated, mostly residential area
- Site 23: Goods Lane IE, Belper (7.02 ha) – Below average grading – Grading reflects the poor site access
- Site 24: Goods Yard/Derwentside IE, Belper (5.25 ha) – Below average grading – Grading reflects the poor site access and general quality.

2.4 Excluding Site 7: Butterley Works, Ripley and Sites 17, 18, 19, 20 in Belper, which were not included from Policy ED1: 'Development Within Existing Business and Industrial Areas' of the Submission Local Plan, as is discussed above, leaves 19 Employment Areas which remain relevant. An updated assessment and grading for those 20 Employment Areas is undertaken in Section 3.0 of this Report.

² Site 21: Nottingham Road/Kilburn Road, Belper was redeveloped for housing prior to the 2021 Employment Land Review

3.0 EMPLOYMENT AREAS ANALYSIS

Introduction

3.1 This Section provides an analysis of the 20 remaining Employment Areas. As set out in Table 2, the analysis comprises:

- Description of the Area, considering strengths and weaknesses and any recent/consented developments as evidence of ongoing growth
- The Occupancy Rate, a measure of current performance based on unit occupancy
- Number and Detail of Past Transactions (property sales and lettings) over 2015-2025, which provides evidence of Area demand and market activity
- Area Constraints, physical constraints which may affect the operation and market demand in the Area.

3.2 These factors are then considered together to provide a justified grading.

Table 2 – Area Analysis

Area Name (Area Size, ha)	Area Description, Including Any Recent Developments	Approx. Number of Units (Occupancy Rate, Percent)	Number and Details of Transactions Over 2015-2025	Area Constraints	Updated Grading	Grading Justification
Alfreton and Somercotes						
Site 1: Meadow Lane Industrial Estate, Alfreton (26.10)	Traditional industrial estate, of average quality, accommodating a range of local businesses in low density industrial, warehouse and open storage sites, on an edge of settlement location. The Area has seen no significant new developments, since 2021.	115 (98.7)	Six industrial lettings of 1,600-2,100 sqm. Achieved rents £4.00-11.00/sqft (£43-118/sqm). One industrial sale – 580 sqm	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area, mostly along streets - Some of the north of the site is in Flood Zone 2, associated with a small watercourse - Public rights of way pass through the west of the Area - Community Woodland to the north - Housing adjoins the Area to the north and south - Access is via residential roads - Water treatment plant to the north west - In a Hazardous Substances Consultation Zone (Submission Plan Policy EN12)	Average	The industrial estate is large and well occupied but offers premises of average quality to mostly local firms and has seen only modest market activity over the last decade.
Site 2: Cotes Park Industrial Estate, Alfreton (Incorporating Alfreton Trading Estate) (174.24)	By some margin the largest industrial estate in the Borough, home to many of Amber Valley's largest employers and a focus investment into B2/B8 premises on the A38 Corridor. The estate is diverse and includes some services and retail/wholesale, focused along Nottingham Road. The Area has seen recent developments, but these have been limited to small scale infill development to create schemes of light industrial units or the subdivision of larger properties to create similar multi-occupancy premises.	899 (98.8)	76 industrial lettings of 500-14,800 sqm. Achieved rents £3.00-8.10/sqft (£32-87/sqm). Eight industrial sales – 1,500-7,300 sqm. Two office lettings of 130-190 sqm. Achieved rents £9.00/sqft (£97/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area, mostly along streets - The Area surrounds a Local Nature Reserve in the east – Pennytown Ponds, Somercotes. Defined as a Local Wildlife Site in Submission Plan Policy EN8. There is a second small Local Wildlife Site in the west - Public rights of way pass through the east of the Area - Other areas of woodland bound the Area to the east and west - Housing adjoins the Area to the south - Includes a Hazardous Substances Consultation Zone (Submission Plan Policy EN12)	Above Average	By some margins the largest industrial estate in the Borough, providing a diverse mix of premises aimed at meeting both local and strategic needs. It is a focus for larger industrial businesses in Amber Valley and has a prominent position on the A38 Corridor. While the Area has some physical constraints, these are clearly not affecting its operation and Cotes Park has seen extensive market activity since 2015. There are already some retail and hot food uses in the Area, but these have not significantly expanded in the last decade.
Site 3: Alfreton Industrial Estate/Thornton Park, Alfreton (32.45)	Strategic industrial site, dominated by the secure Thornton's production facility and HQ offices. Also includes several large self-contained office buildings, occupied by other companies. The north of the area comprises an area of services, including hot food, hotel, petrol filling station and a fire station.	17 (86.4)	Two office lettings of 170-530 sqm. No stated rent. Five office sales – 190-445 sqm.	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area, mostly along streets - Public rights of way pass through the Area - Woodland surrounds the Area	Good	Good quality industrial estate, prominently located off the A38. It includes Thornton's, one of the largest employers in the Borough, however, it also offers larger self-contained offices which are not found in significant numbers anywhere else in Amber Valley. These are key premises for marketing at the strategic level. Retail and hot food uses in the Area are limited to a defined service station which could be excluded from any allocation.
Site 4: Pye Bridge Industrial Estate, Somercotes (20.21)	Local industrial estate of low physical quality. Local access is poor although the Area is relatively close to the M1. It is dominated by concrete production plants and steel fabricators. Some of the larger occupiers have consents for	35 (100.0)	One industrial letting of 2,900 sqm. Achieved rent £5.42/sqft (£58/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Public rights of way pass through the east of the Area - Woodland surrounds much of the Area	Below Average	Local industrial estate of low physical quality and constrained access. Although all the premises appear in use, it has seen only negligible market activity since 2015.

	small scale expansion, within their sites.					
Site 5: Greenhill Lane Industrial Estate, Riddings (17.60)	Traditional industrial estate of average quality, mostly mid-sized B2/B8 units. Access is via residential streets but does include larger B-Roads. No recent developments.	26 (88.9)	16 industrial lettings of 60-2,150 sqm. Achieved rents £3.00-11.00/sqft (£32-118/sqm). Two industrial sales – 2,900-8,300 sqm	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area, mostly along streets - Housing adjoins the Area, to the north and east	Average	Active, but relatively small scale local industrial estate.
Ripley						
Site 25: Riverside/Bullbridge Hill, Ambergate (15.64)	Poorly located and low quality, ageing premises in four adjacent plots. Includes low density premises for several large employers and motor trade premises on main road frontages. Land in the east, previously included in the Area, is now being developed for housing. No recent E(g)/B2/B8 developments.	45 (100.0)	No recorded transactions	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - The west of the Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the River Amber. Businesses have reported recent flooding. - SSSI to the north - Various listed Buildings adjacent - Woodland and some homes surround different parts of the Area - Parts of the Area fall into the Derwent Valley Mills World Heritage Site Buffer Zone (Submission Local Plan Policy EN5)	Below Average	Low quality industrial estate. Includes some larger premises but has seen no investment or market transactions in at least a decade. Large portions of the Area have been lost to housing.
Site 26: Denby Hall Business Park (23.64)	Modern business park in reasonable location, close to A38. The bulk of the Area is now developed for major B2/B8 occupiers including SC Johnson and TechnoCargo. There have been significant plans for growth on greenfield land to the west, that have not been delivered to date. These comprise a scheme of six large B/B8 units, totalling 71,246 sqm, on 22.68 ha, mostly to allow major local employers to grow (App. No. AVA/2019/0463, approved in outline, at Appeal).	29 (100.0)	Two industrial lettings of 10,000-11,000 sqm. Achieved rents £10.00/sqft (£108/sqm). Five industrial sales – 210-20,000 sqm Three office lettings of 130-190 sqm. Achieved rents £5.00/sqft (£54/sqm). Two office sales – 200-700 sqm	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Large are of woodland to the north - Housing adjoins to the north	Good	A key source of larger, modern B2/B8 units in Amber Valley along with modern offices. Denby Hall has been a focus for inward investment and transactions of units greater than 10,000 sqm in the Borough. Although the existing scheme is now full, there are consented proposals for a second scheme of large B2/B8 units on adjacent land.
Site 6: Peasehill Industrial Estate, Peasehill (17.09)	Traditional industrial estate, mostly comprising smaller average quality units. The Area does accommodate some higher value science and technology businesses in the north. Access is through residential areas. The south of the site is in low density open storage and aggregate storage uses, associated with nearby quarries. Recent development limited to the small-scale expansion of existing local occupiers.	21 (100.0)	Five industrial lettings of 250-1,300 sqm. Achieved rents £3.00-4.00/sqft (£32-43/sqm)	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Public rights of way pass through the Area. Ripley Greenway to the west - Housing adjoins the Area in the north - Areas of woodland to the south - Access is through residential areas	Average	Small, local scale industrial estate of average physical quality.
Site 8: Codnor Gate Industrial Estate, Ripley (26.14)	Large local industrial estate, comprising modern, reasonable quality units and with good access. Accommodates a range of major employers including Manthorpe. No recent	57 (94.7)	Seven industrial lettings of 500-1,000 sqm. Achieved rent £3.00-4.70/sqft (£32-51/sqm). Three industrial sales – 433-2,400 sqm One office letting of 530 sqm. No stated rent.	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - One Listed Building to the south - Public rights of way pass through the Area	Above Average	Major industrial estate for Ripley, accommodating many of the settlement's larger industrial employers in modern premises. A key source of mid-sized and larger B2/B8 premises.

	developments.			• Pylons cross the eastern and northern parts of the Area • Large area of woodland to the east		
Site 9: Heage Road Industrial Estate, Ripley (6.46)	Average quality local industrial estate, mostly comprising mid-sized B2/B8 units. Access passes through various residential areas. No recent developments.	51 (86.3)	Six industrial lettings for 135-1,400 sqm. Achieved rents £6.00-12.00/sqft (£65-129/sqm) 16 office lettings (Epos House) for 30-110 sqm. Achieved rents £13-22/sqft (£140-237/sqm).	• Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area • Housing adjoins to the east and west	Average	Average quality industrial estate, mostly accommodating established local firms within the Ripley settlement area.
Heanor						
Site 10: Chrysalis Business Park/Langley Bridge Industrial Estate, Langley Mill (8.51)	Modern industrial and office units, with a direct link to the adjacent A610, and to the M1 further east. It overlaps with the historic Cromford Canal/Langley Mill locks. No recent developments.	44 (95.5)	10 industrial lettings for 125-1,230 sqm. Achieved rents £4.40-6.00/sqft (£47-65/sqm). Three industrial sales – 140-320 sqm One office letting for 200 sqm. Achieved rents £8.50/sqft (£91/sqm)	• Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area • Most of the Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the River Erewash and the Cromford Canal, which pass through the centre of the Area. Businesses have reported recent flooding. • Land in the south of the Area comprises the Langley Locks, of the Cromford Canal, which are a Conservation Area • Public rights of way pass through the Area • Housing adjoins to the west	Above Average	The two Employment Areas of Langley Mill are a key source of higher quality industrial premises, including some larger B2/B8 units accommodating national firms. Both enjoy very prominent positions on the strategic road network. Flood risk will likely prevent further growth here but the existing property offer is of high value for the Borough and, in the north at least, has seen a reasonable amount of recent market activity.
Site 11: Access 26, Langley Mill (21.67)	Scheme of large modern B2/B8 units in a prominent position off the A610, with retail and hot food uses on the frontage. Includes large modern B2/B8 units for occupiers such as DHL and Warburton. A historic focus for inward investment into the Borough. No recent developments.	50 (94.0)	Only renewals of existing leases recorded here. One industrial sale – 2,600 sqm.	• Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area • Most of the Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the River Erewash and the Cromford Canal, which pass through the Area • Housing adjoins to the west	Above Average	The two Employment Areas of Langley Mill are a key source of higher quality industrial premises, including some larger B2/B8 units accommodating national firms. Both enjoy very prominent positions on the strategic road network. Flood risk will likely prevent further growth here but the existing property offer is of high value for the Borough and, in the north at least, has seen a reasonable amount of recent market activity.
Site 12: Bailey Brook Industrial Estate, Langley Mill (4.41)	Small, local industrial estate, offering reasonable quality smaller industrial units aimed at micro firms. Good access along the A608. Recent development is limited to extensions of existing premises. Land in the east has been lost to housing.	32 (100.0)	11 industrial lettings for 63-1,200 sqm. Achieved rents £5.10-14.40/sqft (£55-155/sqm).	• Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area • Most of the Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the Bailey Brook which passes through the Area. Businesses have reported recent flooding. • Housing and sports grounds adjoin to the north	Average	Small local industrial estate, of reasonable quality, but focused at meeting micro business needs. Flood risk may make further growth unlikely here.
Site 13: Sawmills Industrial Park, Heanor Road, Heanor (13.53)	Moderate quality mid-sized industrial estate with reasonable access west along the A6007, to the A610. Includes a large distribution facility for major employer Courtaulds. Some units on the A6007 frontage are in retail use. There are development proposals to sub-divide one unit and build a battery storage facility in the Area.	29 (89.7)	Two industrial lettings for 95-330 sqm. No stated rent.	• Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area • Bailey Brook runs to the north, surrounding land is in Flood Zones 2 and 3 • Public rights of way pass along the eastern and southern edges of the site • Overhead lines pass through the Area to a large substation within the Area • Housing adjoins to the north	Average	Moderate quality mid-sized industrial estate. Access is good and there is one large employer, but most premises are configured to meet local needs only.

Site 14: Heanor Gate Industrial Estate, (36.47)	Major industrial estate, with a diverse offer of modern B2 and B8 units, accommodating both local and strategic businesses. Although access is through town centre, the Area is close to A610 link to the M1. Includes some trade uses. No recent developments. Land in the west has been lost to housing.	99 (94.9)	Four industrial lettings for 150-2,800 sqm. Achieved rents £3.75-6.00/sqft (£40-65/sqm). 12 industrial sales – 380-3,900 sqm. Four office lettings for 30-110 sqm. Achieved rents £14.00/sqft (£151/sqm)	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Shipley Country Park to the south - Public rights of way pass through the Area - Housing adjoins to the north and west	Average	Substantial industrial estate which does accommodate some larger employers but mostly meets local business needs. Access is through the Heanor settlement area, putting some limits on the scale of new development which would be possible here and market activity, since 2015, has been modest.
Site 15: Cromford Road, Langley Mill (1.64)	Small average quality industrial estate with reasonable access. Older premises but well used overall and meeting a lot of micro business needs. No recent developments.	12 (91.7)	Two industrial lettings for 470-1,620 sqm. Achieved rents £5.80-6.75/sqft (£62-73/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Housing and a caravan site adjoin to the north	Average	Small average quality industrial estate with reasonable access, meeting a lot of micro business needs.
Site 16: Langley Park/Eastview Terrace, Langley Mill (3.31)	Moderate quality industrial estate in a mostly residential area, focused towards meeting micro business needs. Constrained access through narrow residential streets. No recent developments.	29 (96.6)	Seven industrial lettings for 140-600 sqm. Achieved rents £1.80-3.00/sqft (£19-32/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - The Area is in a mostly residential area, with access via residential streets	Average	Moderate quality industrial estate in a mostly residential area, focused towards meeting micro business needs..Constrained access would limit the scale of future growth which could be delivered here.
Belper						
Site 22: Bulls Moor, Nottingham Road/Kilburn Road, Belper (14.82 ha)	Comprises large modern factory for Vaillant with expansion land to the rear, in a mostly residential area but off an A-Road. There are historic plans to expand the Vaillant facility and build other premises, to the south, but these have never been progressed.	2 (100.0)	Single occupied unit, no past transactions	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - Some land in the north is in Flood Zones 2 and 3, associated with Coppice Brook. - Public rights of way pass through the Area	Average	Vaillant is a major employer which should be protected overall but sits within a solus specialist property which cannot meet wider premises needs. Past attempts to grow and diversify the offer of industrial premises here have not been delivered.
Site 23: Goods Lane Industrial Estate, Belper (7.02)	Reasonable quality buildings and area, but located in the backlands, with narrow access in places. The bulk of the Area is occupied by Nelson Distribution, plus some smaller units in the north which are in trade use. No recent developments.	30 (100.0)	Two industrial lettings for 290-400 sqm. Achieved rents £6.00-10.00/sqft (£65-108/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - The Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the River Derwent to the west - The Area falls into the wider Belper and Milford Conservation Area. It also falls into the Derwent Valley Mills World Heritage Site Buffer Zone (Submission Local Plan Policy EN5).	Below Average	Grading reflects the backland nature of the Area, its physical constraints and limitations on access. Also, the mixed character of the Area, with a lot of the premises in trade use.
Site 24: Goods Yard/Derwentside Industrial Estate, Belper (5.25)	Modern premises, including offices and a large warehouse for DS Smith Packaging in a strong position on the A6. Land east of the A6 is under development for housing. No recent employment developments.	24 (100.0)	Two industrial lettings for 290-7,300 sqm. Achieved rents £6.00-10.00/sqft (£65-108/sqm). Four office lettings (Heritage Business Centre) for 84-790 sqm. Achieved rents £9.00-14.00/sqft (£97-151/sqm).	- Some areas of surface water flooding in the Area - The Area falls into Flood Zones 2 and 3 associated with the River Derwent to the west - The Area falls into the wider Belper and Milford Conservation Area. It also falls into the Derwent Valley Mills World Heritage Site Buffer Zone (Submission Local Plan Policy EN5) - Several listed buildings, including private homes, front the site on the A6 Derby Road.	Above Average	Although a lot of this Area has been lost to housing, that which remains, on the west side of the A6, is generally of high quality, including modern multi-occupancy offices and a large warehouse for DS Smith Packaging. The Area has a very prominent location on the A6.

Source: Various, 2025

4.0 CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

- 4.1 This Study has provided an updated assessment of the 25, later reduced to 20, Employment Areas (industrial estates and business parks) of Amber Valley. The goal of this was to identify high quality Areas which may justify additional protections, in the Local Plan, from Changes of Use applications which could undermine the ongoing functioning of the location. The report was published in response to a request, made by the Amber Valley Local Plan EiP Inspectors, in a letter dated 7th January, for further research and clarification into this matter.
- 4.2 In Section 3.0 an analysis of the 20 Areas was completed, looking at Area physical quality, occupancy, market activity (demand) and physical constraints. This was then used to grade each Area Good-Poor, reflecting the grading system used previously in the Amber Valley Employment Land Review (2021) (see Table 1, Section 1.0).
- 4.3 Within that system, Areas which receive a grading of 'Good' or 'Above Average', are locations of high physical quality, with limited physical constraints, and with a premises offer which has, and will likely continue to, compete for investment in larger than local market. **These Good or Above Average Employment Areas would thus be the logical locations to receive additional protection in the Submission Local Plan from potentially harmful changes of use.** Areas graded 'Average' or 'Below Average' primarily meet local business needs and may have greater constraints in matters like access. In such locations, there is much less justification for reducing the Permitted Development Rights intended to deliver a greater range of economic activity. No Area received a grading of 'Poor' which indicates that it should not be protected in the Local Plan, at all, for E(g)/B-Class uses.
- 4.4 **For those Good or Above Average Employment Areas which are to receive increased protection, that protection should extend to development sites which fall within, or adjacent to, the Areas. This is to ensure that new developments within these locations protect and maintain their mostly E(g)/B-Class character.**
- 4.5 **Finally, it is assumed that any E(g), B2, B8 employment uses which fall outside 20 Areas assessed would not receive additional protections in the Local Plan.** The intention of the policy change is to provide focused protection to high value economic locations with Amber Valley. It is not proposed that the Local Plan protect

E(g)/B-Class employment premises across the wider Borough, which would represent a more significant alteration of Permitted Development Rights that could impact on the natural churn and re-use of older stock as well as the provision of other employment generating uses such as retail.

- 4.6 Table 3 shows the Areas by grading, highlighting those locations suitable for a greater level of protection in the Local Plan, summarising the justification for each grading and the contribution each Employment Area makes to the wider employment supply in the Borough.

Table 3 – Employment Area Grading Summary

Area Name	Updated Grading	Grading Justification	Role in the Amber Valley Economy	Area Should Receive Additional Protections in the Local Plan, Yes/No
Site 3: Alfreton Industrial Estate/Thornton Park, Alfreton	Good	Very prominent industrial estate, accommodating a major industrial employer, but also several high-grade modern offices. Existing retail/hot food uses are limited to a defined service area.	The Thornton's facility is a strategic employer for Amber Valley, while it also has some of the best large offices in the Borough, suitable for marketing to service sector business at a regional scale.	Yes
Site 26: Denby Hall Business Park	Good	A key source of larger, modern B2/B8 units in Amber Valley and a likely focus for future growth	Recently the main source of B2/B8 units, larger than 10,000 sqm in size, suitable for marketing at the regional and national level. Delivery of a further phase of development would allow this role to continue.	Yes
Site 2: Cotes Park Industrial Estate, Alfreton (Incorporating Alfreton Trading Estate)	Above Average	By some margins the largest industrial estate in the Borough, providing a diverse mix of premises aimed at meeting both local and strategic needs, in a prominent position off the A38..	The industrial estate serves companies of all sizes but has a key role supporting many of the Borough's large and mid-sized manufacturing companies. It contains a critical mass of companies which will serve as a draw to other investment.	Yes
Site 8: Codnor Gate Industrial Estate, Ripley	Above Average	Major industrial estate for Ripley, accommodating many of the settlement's larger industrial employers in modern premises.	It is a key source of mid-sized and larger B2/B8 premises for Ripley.	Yes
Site 10: Chrysalis Business Park/Langley Bridge Industrial Estate, Langley Mill	Above Average	The two Employment Areas of Langley Mill are a key source of higher quality industrial premises, including some larger B2/B8	It is a key source of mid-sized and larger B2/B8 premises	Yes

		units accommodating national firms. Both enjoy very prominent positions on the strategic road network.		
Site 11: Access 26, Langley Mill	Above Average	The two Employment Areas of Langley Mill are a key source of higher quality industrial premises, including some larger B2/B8 units accommodating national firms. Both enjoy very prominent positions on the strategic road network.	It is a key source of mid-sized and larger B2/B8 premises	Yes
Site 24: Goods Yard/Derwentside Industrial Estate, Belper	Above Average	Includes a small number of high quality premises, including modern multi-occupancy offices and a large warehouse for DS Smith Packaging. The Area has a very prominent location on the A6.	A useful source of modern office space, a product not common across Amber Valley, and home to several large local employers.	Yes
Site 1: Meadow Lane Industrial Estate, Alfreton	Average	The industrial estate is large and well occupied but offers premises of average quality to mostly local firms and has seen only modest market activity over the last decade.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs.	No
Site 5: Greenhill Lane Industrial Estate, Riddings	Average	Active, but relatively small scale local industrial estate.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs.	No
Site 6: Peasehill Industrial Estate, Peasehill	Average	Small, local scale industrial estate of average physical quality.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs.	No
Site 9: Heage Road Industrial Estate, Ripley	Average	Average quality industrial estate, mostly accommodating established local firms within the Ripley settlement area.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs, mostly from established local firms.	No
Site 12: Bailey Brook Industrial Estate, Langley Mill	Average	Small local industrial estate, of reasonable quality, but focused at meeting micro business needs.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs. Particularly a good local source of start-up and early growth premises.	No
Site 13: Sawmills Industrial Park, Heanor Road, Heanor	Average	Moderate quality mid-sized industrial estate. Access is good and there is one large employer, but most premises are configured to meet local needs only.	Average quality industrial estate, mostly meeting local business needs.	No
Site 14: Heanor Gate Industrial Estate, Heanor	Average	Substantial industrial estate which does accommodate some larger employers but mostly meets local business needs. And with some constraints on access.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs.	No
Site 15: Cromford Road, Langley Mill	Average	Small average quality industrial estate with reasonable access, meeting a lot of micro business needs.	Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs. Particularly a good local source of start-up and early	No

Site 16: Langley Park/Eastview Terrace, Langley Mill	Average	Moderate quality industrial estate in a mostly residential area, focused towards meeting micro business needs.	growth premises. Average quality industrial estate, meeting local business needs. Particularly a good local source of start-up and early growth premises.	No
Site 22: Bulls Moor, Nottingham Road/Kilburn Road, Belper	Average	Vaillant is a major employer which should be protected overall but sits within a solus specialist property which cannot meet wider premises needs. Past attempts to grow and diversify the offer of industrial premises here have not been delivered.	Facilities for a major industrial employer.	No
Site 4: Pye Bridge Industrial Estate, Somercotes	Below Average	Local industrial estate of low physical quality and constrained access. Although all the premises appear in use, it has seen only negligible market activity since 2015.	Local industrial estate, providing budget quality premises and open storage space to a range of bad neighbour occupiers who might struggle to find suitable accommodation elsewhere.	No
Site 25: Riverside/Bullbridge Hill, Ambergate	Below Average	Low quality industrial estate. Includes some larger premises but has seen no investment or market transactions in at least a decade. Large portions of the Area have been lost to housing.	Local industrial estate, serving a range of mostly established firms in a main road location. Also the only Employment Area which falls significantly outside of the four main towns so is in a position to serve more of the rural economy.	No
Site 23: Goods Lane Industrial Estate, Belper	Below Average	Grading reflects the backland nature of the Area, its physical constraints and limitations on access. Also, the mixed character of the Area, with a lot of the premises in trade use.	Mixed Area, accommodating a range of trade businesses and a large haulage firm.	No

Source: BE Group, 2025